

Examiner
only

7. Warfarin is an anticoagulant and has been used as a poison to control the rat population since the 1950s. Rats die from internal bleeding a few days after eating poisoned bait. In 1960, warfarin resistant rats were found in Montgomeryshire. In the years that followed, studies found that the area where rats resistant to warfarin were detected was expanding at a rate of approximately 5 km/year.

Use your knowledge of natural selection to explain how resistance to warfarin developed and spread. [6 QER]

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